AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)
Registered NPC: 2026/521895/08
SARS Approved PBO: 930092287

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CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

MTN Foundation × ASCO

Connected Futures: Youth Digital Skills and Community Empowerment Pilot

Requested CSI investment: R100,000

Proposed implementation area: South Africa; one underserved rural or peri-urban community to be selected through a documented needs assessment and confirmed with MTN Foundation

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **MTN Foundation** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Connected Futures: Youth Digital Skills and Community Empowerment Pilot**. The proposed request is **R100,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** Connected Futures: Youth Digital Skills and Community Empowerment Pilot in South Africa; one underserved rural or peri-urban community to be selected through a documented needs assessment and confirmed with MTN Foundation, benefiting Proposed: unemployed or underemployed young people, with intentional inclusion of young women and girls, learners and community members facing device, connectivity or digital-skills barriers; final participant profile should be agreed with MTN and local stakeholders. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with MTN Foundation's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting
R100,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
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The proposed project

Project title
Connected Futures: Youth Digital Skills and Community Empowerment Pilot

Implementation period
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

Location
South Africa; one underserved rural or peri-urban community to be selected through a documented needs assessment and confirmed with MTN Foundation

Target beneficiaries
Proposed: unemployed or underemployed young people, with intentional inclusion of young women and girls, learners and community members facing device, connectivity or digital-skills barriers; final participant profile should be agreed with MTN and local stakeholders.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: deliver a 6-month community digital-skills pilot for 100 young people, with at least 50% young women and girls, subject to baseline validation and funder agreement.
- Proposed: provide structured training in foundational digital literacy, online safety, productivity, job-readiness and introductory entrepreneurship; advanced modules such as AI or cybersecurity should be included only if delivery capacity is confirmed.
- Proposed: establish or strengthen one accessible community learning point with a device-use and digital-support schedule; do not promise devices, data or connectivity from MTN unless approved in writing.
- Proposed: provide at least 20 facilitated employment, entrepreneurship or further-learning referrals and track completion, skills gain and post-training outcomes for at least three months.
- Proposed: submit baseline/endline data, attendance records, safeguarding documentation, beneficiary disaggregation and a close-out report aligned to MTN reporting requirements.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the

specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why MTN Foundation?

A cautious alignment exists: ASCO is a South African NPC with SARS-approved PBO reference 930092287, and its proposed public-benefit focus on digital inclusion, youth development and community empowerment is directionally consistent with MTN Foundation priorities on digital skills, youth inclusion, underserved communities, education and partnerships for scale. A R100,000 request could be presented as a locally deliverable pilot or implementation partnership, with clear safeguarding, monitoring and sustainability provisions. This is only a fit assessment; it does not establish MTN sponsorship, an existing partnership, eligibility, or funding availability.

Verified company context

- The MTN Group Foundation describes itself as an independent pan-African organisation focused on bridging the digital divide and expanding economic opportunity through digital skills, affordable devices, technology and partnerships.
- Its stated immediate focus areas are Digital Skills for Digital Jobs and Access to Affordable Devices; it also identifies education, healthcare, financial inclusion and entrepreneurship as areas for potential expansion.
- Its inclusion priorities include youth inclusion, women and girls' empowerment, marginalised and excluded communities, refugee and displacement inclusion, and disability inclusion.
- The Foundation's stated geography is Africa through MTN's multi-market footprint; the FY2024 Integrated Report specifically documents MTN SA Foundation work in South Africa.
- The FY2024 report says MTN SA Foundation initiatives focus on education, digital skills, entrepreneurship, arts and culture, and promoting women and youth in the digital economy.
- The FY2024 report says MTN SA launched the MTN Skills Academy, including skills such as cybersecurity, AI and machine learning, to improve youth employment prospects; it also describes the Connecting Every Child campaign with the Department of Basic Education, aimed at supporting 30,000 digital devices for learners in rural and disadvantaged communities.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R60,000	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R8,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R6,000	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R8,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R7,000	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R7,000	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R4,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	**R100,000**	**Equals the proposed request.**

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding
Company funds the proposed project at R100,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

Use MTN's official Foundation contact form at https://www.mtn.com/foundation-contact-us/ and select either "Make an enquiry for funding" or "Become a partner"; the form requests full name, job title, email, work number and message. ASCO may also include its website https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/ and phone +27 76 757 5773 in the message. No public Foundation email address or separate open application portal was found on the reviewed official pages.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- The official pages reviewed do not publish a detailed open-grant eligibility policy, application deadline, minimum or maximum award, geographic restriction within South Africa, or decision timeline.
- The partner page presents a partnership invitation rather than a promise of funding; MTN may require co-investment, a capable implementation model, measurable outcomes, governance evidence and alignment with its internal priorities.
- ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.
- No MTN commitment, completed ASCO result, existing partnership, or MTN provision of devices/ connectivity should be claimed unless separately documented in writing.
- The proposed location and output numbers below are recommendations, not MTN-approved sites or targets.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **MTN Foundation** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

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Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://www.mtn.com/about-foundation/
2. https://www.mtn.com/our-strategy-focus-areas/
3. https://www.mtn.com/become-a-partner/
4. https://www.mtn.com/foundation-contact-us/
5. https://www.mtn.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/MTN-Group-FY-24-Integrated-Report_spreads.pdf
6. https://www.mtn-investor.com/mtn-ir2024/operational-performance-summary.php

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.